

# EU strategy to tackle aviation's 'automotive moment'

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## 【要点】

- ・ EUの新たな航空戦略は、サプライチェーンの強化と外国への依存削減を通じて、欧州の産業的リーダーシップを維持することを目指している。
- ・ 航空業界は、米国と中国との激しい競争に直面する「自動車産業のような転換点」を迎えており、EU の介入が必要とされている。
- ・ EU は約500の軍事・モビリティの重要地点のうち、優先度の高いボトルネックを2030年までに完成させる方針である。
- ・ 空港のエネルギーコストと規制コストが国際競争相手より高く、単一供給業者への依存も課題となっている。
- ・ 空港が高速鉄道など複数の交通機関と接続し、多機能化することで接続性を向上させることが戦略の主要テーマとなる見込みである。

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## 【メール原文】

Navigating the complex world of EU mobility policy and infrastructure. By TOMMASO LECCA with JORDYN DAHL and MARTINA SAPIO SNEAK PEEK — The European C

Navigating the complex world of EU mobility policy and infrastructure.

By TOMMASO LECCA

with JORDYN DAHL and MARTINA SAPIO

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SNEAK PEEK

— The European Commission says its upcoming aviation strategy will protect Europe's industrial leadership, as the sector warns it could face the same risks automakers are already struggling with.

— Transport Commissioner Apostolos Tzitzikostas said Brussels wants the priority bottlenecks among the roughly 500 military-mobility hotspots to be completed before 2030, even if the full list takes longer.

— A new report argues the IAA will be costly and could ultimately leave the EU even further behind in the global innovation race.

Good morning, and welcome to Morning Mobility.

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DRIVING THE DAY

**EU'S NEW AVIATION STRATEGY TO TACKLE SUPPLY CHAIN RISKS:** The EU's upcoming aviation strategy will seek to preserve the bloc's industrial leadership by strengthening supply chains, reducing foreign dependencies, protecting EU standards and tackling inefficiencies, Transport Commissioner Apostolos Tzitzikostas said at an event Tuesday at Brussels Airport.

Still in the air: However, while industry broadly agrees that EU intervention is needed, uncertainty remains over both the content and the timing of the new strategy. Its adoption, originally planned for the third quarter of this year, is absent from the Commission's latest agenda through the end of November. Two industry representatives told Tommaso they now expect the strategy to be unveiled in early 2027.

Why it matters: Bruno Fichfeux, Airbus' head of future programs, warned that European aviation is facing an "automotive moment" as foreign competition intensifies.

From wings to wheels: Speaking on a panel at the Commission event, Fichfeux warned of "a very tough competition" in the long term for European aviation, both from the U.S. on next-generation aircraft, and from the "incredibly disciplined, state-supported Chinese industry," similar to what European carmakers are already facing.

Tzitzikostas identified supply chain vulnerabilities as one of the sector's main challenges, noting that "in some cases, we are dependent on single-source providers." He also warned that "our airlines and airports face higher energy and regulatory costs," tipping the scales in favor of international competitors.

Better connectivity and hybrid warfare: Perhaps hinting at the major themes in the new strategy, the commissioner stressed the need for airports to invest in becoming "truly multimodal," meaning connected to high-speed rail and other modes of transport to improve connectivity and potentially avoid short-haul flights; and "dual-use," where existing civilian infrastructure is also adapted for military use. He also pointed to emerging threats to the aviation industry, including cyberattacks, GPS jamming and spoofing, drone incursions and climate-related disruptions.

Lack of unity: However, while aircraft manufacturers, airlines, airports and air navigation service providers agree broadly on the need for a new plan to replace the 2015 Aviation Strategy for Europe, they have different — and sometimes conflicting — ideas about what Brussels should prioritize.

Take air traffic management: A more integrated, modernized and efficiently managed European airspace was one of the goals of the 2015 strategy. Tzitzikostas said air traffic management delays cost the sector "more than €2 billion only in 2025." Ourania Georgoutsakou, managing director of lobby group Airlines for Europe, agreed on the need to improve ATM performance, but rejected calls for additional funding. "The money is there. It's paid by ATM charges," she said, referring to the fees airlines pay air navigation service providers.

ATM providers disagree. The sector needs "proper financing for future investments," said Philipp Piber, managing director of Austro Control. "We also need incentives in our regulation that allows us not just to look at the short-term cost effectiveness, but also for long-term investment that helps us delivering the capacity we need in the future," he added.

\*\* Every weekday afternoon, the Brussels Playbook Capitals newsletter draws on our reporting across national capitals to look ahead at what is shaping the EU agenda next. Sign up here. \*\*

MILITARY MOBILITY

**COMMISSION BETS BIG ON MILITARY MOBILITY:** Transport Commissioner Tzitzikostas said Tuesday that Brussels wants the priority bottlenecks among the roughly 500 military-mobility hotspots identified with NATO completed before 2030, even if the full list takes longer.

Still some way to go: Speaking at Connecting Europe Days, he also said the Commission wants the so-called military Schengen of faster, harmonized cross-border permissions and a common digital system in place by 2027. The timetable for the proposal, scooped by us , puts the final trilogue on Dec. 9. But the latest trilogue documents, also seen by us , show co-negotiators are still not aligned on some of the biggest political issues, including the Solidarity Pool, designed to identify and share scarce dual-use assets, and the emergency mechanism to relax normal transport rules when countries need to move a lot of troops and equipment quickly.

Civilians first: DG MOVE chief Magda Kopczyńska, speaking at Connecting Europe Days, framed the discussion around a basic point Brussels has increasingly embraced: military mobility will happen on civilian transport infrastructure, meaning transport policy, defense policy and industry have to work together from the outset. She also reminded the room that Europe's roads, railways, ports and bridges were built for civilian traffic, not for moving armor, brigades and heavy military equipment at speed.

The infrastructure bill: Tzitzikostas estimated that fixing the full set of 500-plus hotspots could cost around €100 billion over the coming years. The next Connecting Europe Facility would provide €17 billion in funding for military mobility, with the rest expected to come from other EU funds, national budgets, institutional investors and defense spending.

And rail is already tight: NATO's Lt. Gen. Kai Rohrschneider warned that some rail capacity is already used at around 90%, meaning large military movements would inevitably displace civilian traffic unless Europe adds more capacity. The same problem applies to ports, bridges, airfields and other links that may simply be too small, too weak or too congested for military requirements.

The military's plea: Generals on the panel stressed that Europe has to tackle infrastructure, rules and actual transport capacity at the same time. Faster permits are useless if there are no trains or trucks available, while better roads and bridges do not help if governments cannot share data quickly enough to know what is usable in a crisis.

## CARS

**CONFLICTING VIEWPOINTS ON AUTONOMOUS DRIVING:** The Commission used the Connecting Europe Days to reveal that three more countries have joined a large-scale testbed for autonomous vehicles, with Portugal, Norway and Slovakia signing the joint declaration that is part of the broader automotive package. But for all the pomp and circumstance, a panel discussion ahead of the signing revealed just how fraught debate is over rolling out autonomous cars in the EU.

Steady does it: Hamburg is one of the EU's test cities for autonomous driving, yet its government is skeptical of scaling the technology too quickly. In a presentation at the transport event on Tuesday, Anjes Tjarks, Hamburg's transport minister, compared robotaxis to the proliferation of e-scooters that led to many cities banning them altogether. "It's not that we don't introduce them, but the question is how," he said.

Workforce issue: Like ride-hailing before it, robotaxis raise concerns for policymakers about employment and the fate of taxi drivers. Germany is still reeling from recent state elections that saw the far-right Alternative for Germany win a major victory on the back of public outcry over layoffs across the country.

“In every European country, democracy in the democratic middle is under pressure from the right,” Tjarks said.

A matter of sovereignty: While policymakers are focused on scale and the speed of rolling out these new technologies, Constance Wendrich, the head of external affairs at Motor AI, said the tech race is a matter of sovereignty. Wendrich says automated fleets are critical infrastructure like solar panels or telecoms and are similarly vulnerable to hacking or being controlled by a foreign entity.

Already behind: “Today not one driverless service anywhere in the world runs on the European autonomous driving stack,” Wendrich told the audience. Motor AI is a Berlin-based company that develops software platforms for autonomous vehicles. In pilot programs across the EU, its American and Chinese technology powering the robotaxis.

THE PRICE OF MADE IN EU: “Made in Europe” is a catchy slogan, but it comes with a cost and could ultimately leave the EU even further behind in the global innovation race. That, at least, is the conclusion of a report published today by the Confederation of Swedish Enterprise on the hidden costs of the Industrial Accelerator Act.

Mounting pressure: The lobbying machine is going into overdrive as the IAA bill enters crucial stages of negotiation in the European Parliament and the Council. Catch up on the biggest points of contention with this explainer .

Production costs: Restricting the pool of eligible suppliers under EU-origin requirements has a high risk of backfiring, according to the Swedish report, our colleague Francesca Micheletti reports. The report estimates that moving production from current non-EU suppliers to EU territory could increase costs by 30-40% for products in the strategic sectors the bloc is trying to protect: battery components and cells, and electric buses.

## PIT STOPS

From us — scoop : Parliament’s lead negotiators for electrifying corporate fleets in member states have tabled three amendments that would increase the mandatory targets.

During her Connecting Europe Days speech , Commission President Ursula von der Leyen gave electric trucks a rare prominent mention, touting their growth potential and the need for cross-border charging corridors — notable after the industry had complained that heavy-duty road transport was being overlooked in Brussels’ clean-tech push.

She also said that in light of transport infrastructure increasingly being exposed to climate risks, the Commission will present a new European framework for climate resilience next month.

## Headlines

Here’s a recap of yesterday’s news, along with Pro articles and alerts from overnight.

EU to deepen ties with Canada as ‘trusted supplier’ of energy and minerals, draft document says  
Brussels turns to Canada to reduce its exposure to disrupted LNG markets and China-dominated critical mineral supply chains.

By Camille Gijs · Sept 29, 2026, 06:26 pm Europe/Brussels CEST

Andy Burnham keeps his options open on Brexit

The U.K. prime minister said he would lay out different paths for the future EU relationship at a summit later this year.

By Jon Stone, Charlie Cooper · Sept 29, 2026, 06:19 pm Europe/Brussels CEST

Commission plans new China trade measures by year's end

The EU executive's planned "DiversifyEU" package could include tariffs and other tools to push businesses in critical sectors to source from multiple suppliers.

By Carlo Martuscelli · Sept 29, 2026, 05:17 pm Europe/Brussels CEST

Document: MEPs want to increase corporate fleet targets

By Jordyn Dahl · Sept 29, 2026, 04:25 pm Europe/Brussels CEST

5 battles that will decide EU's 'Made in Europe' push

Europe wants to favor domestic industry. Defining what counts as European — and who should bear the cost — is much harder.

By Aude van den Hove · Sept 29, 2026, 04:19 pm Europe/Brussels CEST

EU officials confident Trump will drop plan to ban diesel exports

Irish Energy Minister Darragh O'Brien said the threat "doesn't look like ... something that would happen."

By Ben Munster · Sept 29, 2026, 11:27 am Europe/Brussels CEST

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